

TNF PHILOSOPHY

MESOCYCLE 2

ARMS PRIORITY

6-8 / 8-12 REPS

GYM

Shoulders & Arms Thickness

Heavier loading · Short head width · Brachialis · Long head tricep · Traps + Back combined

THREE TRACKABLE KEY LIFTS — LOG EVERY SESSION

Overhead press

Add 2.5 kg when you hit 8 clean reps for 2 consecutive sessions.

Cable lateral raise

Move up one increment when 12 clean reps with a 1s pause are achievable for 2 sessions.

Hammer curl

Add 2.5 kg when you hit 12 clean reps with a 3s eccentric for 2 consecutive sessions.

SESSION TRIM GUIDE

FULL SESSION (~80-85 MIN)

- Cable lateral raise
- Incline DB lateral raise
- Reverse pec deck
- Machine preacher curl
- Hammer curl
- Close-grip bench press
- Cable overhead extension
- Face pull + T-bar row → Kelso + Y-raise
- Pec deck (cut first — maintenance only)

SHORT SESSION (~55-60 MIN)

- Cable lateral raise
- Reverse pec deck
- Machine preacher curl
- Hammer curl
- Close-grip bench press
- Face pull + T-bar row → Kelso
- Skip: incline lateral raise
- Skip: cable overhead extension
- Skip: Y-raise and pec deck

Mon
Upper A

Tue
Lower A

Wed
Rest

Thu
Upper B

Fri
Lower B

Sat
Rest

Sun
Rest

● Key lift ● Priority ● Bridge ● Alternate available ● Regression ● Progression

Upper A — Isolation first

Lower A — Quad dominant

Upper B — Press first

Lower B — Posterior chain

Upper A

Lateral raise → incline lateral → rear delt · Arms (preacher + hammer + CGBP + overhead ext) · Traps + Back · Chest maintenance

~80-85 min

1-2 working sets

6-8 and 8-12 reps

side delt isolation opens cold

Shoulders ●●●●● Biceps ●●●●● Triceps ●●●●● Traps+Back ●●●●● Chest ●●●●●

● SHOULDERS — PRIORITY

01 **Cable lateral raise** **KEY LIFT** 2 × 8-12 ▾
Side delt — constant tension · KEY LIFT · opens cold

02 **Incline DB lateral raise** **PRIORITY** 2 × 8-12 ▾
Side delt — lengthened position · stretch-mediated

03 **Reverse pec deck** **PRIORITY** 2 × 8-12 ▾
Rear delt — isolation · 3D shoulder roundness

● **BICEPS — PRIORITY**

04 **Machine preacher curl** **PRIORITY** 2 × 6-8 ▾
Bicep short head — front-facing width · 6-8 reps heavy

05 **Hammer curl** **KEY LIFT** 2 × 8-12 ▾
Brachialis + brachioradialis — overall arm thickness · KEY LIFT

● **TRICEPS — PRIORITY**

06 **Close-grip bench press** **PRIORITY** 2 × 6-8 ▾
Tricep long head + overall tricep mass — heavy compound · 6-8 reps

07 **Cable overhead tricep extension** **PRIORITY** 2 × 8-12 ▾
Tricep long head — stretched position · 8-12 reps

● **TRAPS + BACK — COMBINED**

08 **Cable face pull** **BRIDGE** 2 × 12-15 ▾
Rear delt + mid-trap + external rotators · bridge

09 **Chest-supported T-bar row → Kelso shrug (mechanical drop set)** 2 × 8-10 row / 8-10 Kelso ▾
PRIORITY
Rhomboids + mid-trap · retraction then elevation · no equipment change

10 **Y-raise** **PRIORITY** 2 × 12-15 ▾
Lower trap — scapular depression · posture · shoulder health

● **CHEST — MAINTENANCE**

11 **Pec deck / Cable fly** **MAINTENANCE** 1 × 10-12 ▾
Chest — 1 set only · structural balance · cut first if short on time

MESOCYCLE 2 — DESIGN NOTES**Why lower reps this mesocycle?**

Meso 1 used 15–20 reps — high metabolic stress, pump-driven. Meso 2 uses 6–8 and 8–12 — higher mechanical tension, heavier loads, more myofibrillar stimulus. The muscle adapts to a completely different signal. Alternating between these rep ranges across mesocycles is one of the most effective long-term hypertrophy strategies.

Why arms before back this mesocycle?

Arms are the secondary specialization target this cycle. They are trained immediately after shoulders while still fresh — before back work pre-fatigues the biceps through rowing. The brachialis in particular needs to be at full capacity to handle 6–8 rep loads with a slow eccentric.

Session trim guide

Each upper day has a trim guide showing which exercises to cut first if you are short on time. Shoulders and the first arm exercise of each pairing are never cut. The trim order always starts with chest maintenance, then the second back exercise if applicable, then one arm exercise.

What creates arm thickness from the front?

The brachialis (underneath the bicep — trained by hammer curls and neutral grip work) is the single biggest contributor to overall arm thickness at rest. The short head creates width when viewed straight on. Together they are why this mesocycle prioritizes hammer curls and preacher curls over long head isolation.

Alternates — when to use them

Every exercise has a listed alternate. Use it immediately if the primary station is occupied — do not wait. The alternate always targets the same muscle. Never substitute a lower-priority exercise just because the primary is busy.

Traps and back combined

The T-bar row → Kelso shrug mechanical drop set covers both mid-back thickness and mid-trap stimulus in one block. Face pull serves as the bridge between shoulder and trap stimulus. Barbell shrug on Upper B covers upper trap peak contraction. Y-raise / straight-arm pulldown covers lower trap on both days.